

Up the rails, *down the coast*

BKK
EK374 · 07:35

→ Bangkok

2 NIGHTS

→ Chiang Mai

3 NIGHTS

→ Krabi

3 NIGHTS

→ Khao Sok

3 NIGHTS

→ Bangkok

1 NIGHT

BKK
EK373 · 20:45

◆ At a glance

NOVEMBER 2026

The whole trip on one grid — colour-coded by region, travel days flagged. You land **Sunday the 1st** and fly home Saturday the 14th.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
1 LAND 07:35	2 BANGKOK	3 NIGHT TRAIN	4 CHIANG MAI	5 U CHIANG MAI	6 U CHIANG MAI	7 FLY SOUTH
8 CENTARA	9 CENTARA	10 TRANSFER IN	11 360 ISSARA	12 360 ISSARA	13 FLY TO BKK	14 FLY 20:45

Bangkok

Chiang Mai

Krabi

Khao Sok

→ marks a travel / transit day

Land at 7:35am and give yourself a soft start: temple-hop the old city, eat your way down the Chao Phraya, and shake off the flight before the **night train north**.

SUN

1

NOV

ARRIVE

Land & ease in

- Clear immigration; ARL to Phaya Thai, then BTS Sukhumvit to **Ploen Chit** — the Ritz is a 10-min walk at One Bangkok.
- Late morning: **Wat Pho** and its giant reclining Buddha, then a foot massage at the temple's own school.
- Sunset boat on the Chao Phraya; riverside dinner with **Wat Arun** lit up across the water. Early night — you've earned it.

STAY Ritz-Carlton · 90034653

ARR EK374 07:35 · H2M5FJ

check-in 15:00 — ask early

MON

2

NOV

CITY

Grand old Bangkok

- Open-of-day at the **Grand Palace & Wat Phra Kaew** (Emerald Buddha), before heat and crowds.
- Ferry across to **Wat Arun**; climb the central prang for the view.
- Afternoon: Jim Thompson House or a cool-down spa hour. Evening: **Yaowarat** Chinatown street-food crawl.

STAY Ritz-Carlton

MRT Lumphini 300 m



TUE

3

NOV

DEPART

Markets, then the rails

- Slow morning: a **Maeklong railway + Damnoen Saduak floating market** half-day, or a guided food tour.
- Afternoon: coffee, a massage, and pack an overnight bag you can reach on the train.
- **18:40**: board Special Express #9 at Krung Thep Aphiwat — e-tickets issued. Dinner in the dining car, berths down.

TRAIN #9 18:40 → 07:15 · 34511470

at station by 18:10

SLEEPER #9 ·
TICKETED

STATE RAILWAY OF THAILAND ·
SPECIAL EXPRESS

NIGHT 03

Sleep on
the move

18:40

≈ 13 h · 751 km

07:15

KRUNG THEP APHIWAT

overnight

CHIANG MAI

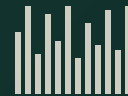
Bangkok · Tue 3 Nov

Wed 4 Nov (+1)

CLASS 2nd A/C sleeper × 2

REF ...6901 / ...6902

KTW → CGM



Be at the station by
18:10.

Wake up in the mountains. Lanna temples, an **ethical elephant day**, jungle waterfalls and cool air — the exhale after Bangkok's heat. Three nights at **U Chiang Mai**, inside the moat.

The room is booked from Tue 3 Nov, the night you're on the train. That night is paid for deliberately: the room is already yours when you step off the sleeper at 07:15 on the 4th, so you walk in and check in on time whatever the train does. The rate is **non-refundable**, so the dates can't be shifted. Breakfast isn't included — about **THB 399** each for the buffet.

Heads-up on lanterns: the famous Yi Peng / Loy Krathong festival lands about **Nov 24–25** this year — roughly ten days after you fly home. You'll narrowly miss the sky lanterns, so plan Chiang Mai around its year-round temples and jungle rather than the festival.

WED

4

NOV

ARRIVE

Off the train, into the Old City

- Arrive 07:15; the room is already held from last night, so go straight there and drop your bags.
- Temple wander on foot: **Wat Chedi Luang**, **Wat Phra Singh**, and the quiet lanes between.
- Evening: the Night Bazaar and a bowl of **khao soi**, the north's signature curry noodle.

STAY U Chiang Mai · 2535552787

arr 07:15



THU

5

NOV

DAY TRIP

Elephants, done right

- Full day at an **ethical sanctuary** (Elephant Nature Park and similar) — feeding and observing, no riding.
- Back by evening; unwind in **Nimman**, the café and craft-beer district.

STAY U Chiang Mai

book the sanctuary ahead



FRI

6

NOV

EXPLORE

Mountain temple & waterfalls

- Morning: **Wat Phra That Doi Suthep**, the gold chedi on the mountain above the city.
- Afternoon: chase waterfalls at **Doi Inthanon** — or keep it slow in the Old City if the morning was enough.
- Repack for the tropics; tomorrow you fly to the Andaman.

STAY U Chiang Mai

check-out 12:00 tomorrow



Fly Chiang Mai → Krabi

CNX → KBV · FD3072 · direct · ticketed

Sat 7 Nov · morning
≈ 2 h in the air

Swap mountains for limestone and sea. [Longtail boats](#), [castaway beaches](#), and karst cliffs rising straight out of turquoise water. Three nights at **Centara Ao Nang**, on the beach.

You land well before check-in. FD3072 puts you in Krabi at 09:55 and the room isn't ready until 15:00, so plan to leave the bags at reception and start the day on the beach. Two things worth asking the hotel for when you arrive: a room **away from the drainage canal** that runs between the wings — it's a known smell complaint — and confirmation of the pool-access room you booked. Rate is **non-refundable**; breakfast is extra, around **THB 325–650** each.

SAT

7

NOV

ARRIVE

Fly south, feet in the sand

- Morning flight down; transfer to **Ao Nang** — about 30 minutes from the airport.
- Afternoon on the beach, first Andaman sunset, a long seafood dinner.

FLY FD3072 CNX–KBV • UYTUHF

STAY Centara Ao Nang • 2535573436

SUN

8

NOV

ISLANDS

Island-hop

- Full-day boat trip: the **Hong Islands** lagoon or the classic **4-Islands** — Phra Nang cave beach, Tup, Chicken, Poda.
- Snorkel, swim, beach lunch; back for sunset.

STAY Centara Ao Nang

reef-safe sunscreen



MON

9

NOV

EXPLORE

Cliffs, jungle & steam

- Sunrise option: the **Tiger Cave Temple's** 1,260 steps for the summit view over the plains.
- Or the inland **Emerald Pool & hot springs** in the rainforest; easy afternoon back at the beach.

STAY Centara Ao Nang

drive to Khao Sok tomorrow

Transfer Krabi → 360° Issara



included in package · meet 500Rai Pier Office, Chiew Larn

Tue 10 Nov · boat 12:00 or 15:30
≈ 2 h road + 1.5 h boat

04 / 05

Khao Sok — *on the lake*

TUE 10 → FRI 13 NOV

Three nights **floating on Cheow Lan Lake** at 360° Issara, ringed by limestone towers in one of the oldest rainforests on earth. The centrepiece of the trip.

Transfers are included. The package covers a private car from Krabi (~2 h) to the 500Rai Pier Office at Chiew Larn, then a 1.5 h longtail. Scheduled boats leave the pier at **12:00 or 15:30 only**. Pack small — you climb down stairs to the boat, and big cases can stay at the pier office. Bring **THB 340 each in cash** for the national park fee.

TUE
10
NOV

ARRIVE

Drive, then the longtail

- Leave Krabi mid-morning — about **2 h by road** to Chiew Larn, for the 12:00 boat.
- **1.5 h by longtail** across the lake, sightseeing on the way; the resort appears like a floating village.
- Check in from 14:00, swim off the deck, set dinner over the water.
17:00: wildlife safari & sunset cruise.

STAY 360° Issara · 0592406

3-Night Essence · all-in

WED
11
NOV

THE LAKE

Nowhere to be

- Kayak straight off your own balcony — each room has one.
- Swim in the fresh water, read, watch the light move across the karsts.
- **Pakarang Cave Trail** at 09:45 — 1.5 km trek plus a bamboo raft (THB 200 each, cash).

STAY 360° Issara

A/C 12:00-06:00 only

THU
12
NOV

DAWN

Last full day on the water

- Morning lake sightseeing — gibbons, hornbills and elephants along the shoreline.
- **Prakai Petch Cave Trail** — swamp forest, small waterfalls, glittering cave (runs Mon/Wed/Sat, so today works).
- Last sunset cruise at 17:00. Pack tonight — **check-out is 10:00**.

STAY 360° Issara

check-out 10:00



Boat, car, then fly → Bangkok

360° Issara → Chiew Larn → Surat Thani (URT) → Bangkok

Fri 13 Nov · boat 10:30
reaches URT ~13:00

05 / 05

Bangkok — *the finale*

FRI 13 → SAT 14 NOV

One night back in the capital, then a **full final day** — the 20:45 flight leaves the whole Saturday open.

FRI

13

NOV

RETURN

Off the lake, into the city

- Breakfast, check out at 10:00, scheduled boat at 10:30, car to Surat Thani — at URT about 13:00.
- **Flight not yet booked. VZ353 18:50 → 20:05** into Suvarnabhumi is the safe default; an afternoon flight to **Don Mueang** lands about two hours earlier and cuts the wait at Surat Thani. (VZ355 at 13:10 needs a THB 5,000 private boat leaving 10:00.)
- From Don Mueang take the **SRT Red Line** to Krung Thep Aphiwat — the 13th is a Friday and the roads will be at their worst.

FLY URT→Bangkok — not booked

STAY Bangkok — not booked

SAT

14

NOV

DEPART

Fly home

- A full last day — ICONSIAM, Ayutthaya, or whatever you missed. Your flight is in the evening.
- Leave the city by **~5:00pm** for Suvarnabhumi — allow for traffic.
- **20:45: EK373** to Dubai, then JFK at 08:15 Sunday.

DEP EK373 20:45 · H2M5FJ

at airport by ~17:45

Before you go

- 01 **Train #9 is ticketed.** Two 2nd-class A/C berths (res. 34511470), Bangkok 18:40 → Chiang Mai 07:15.
- 02 **Booked.** Emirates H2M5FJ, Ritz-Carlton (90034653), Sleeper #9, U Chiang Mai (2535552787), FD3072 (UYTUHF), Centara Ao Nang (2535573436), 360° Issara (0592406). The Krabi transfer is included in the package.
- 03 **Great timing.** Early November is the front edge of the cool, dry season — the Andaman is drying out and Khao Sok is at its lushest.
- 04 **Two things left to book.** The flight off the lake on the 13th, and the last night in Bangkok. VZ353 at 18:50 to Suvarnabhumi fits the resort's 10:30 boat; VZ355 at 13:10 only works with a THB 5,000 private boat. There are also afternoon flights to **Don Mueang** — a different airport, but you sleep in the city that night either way, so it costs nothing on the 14th.
- 05 **Cash for the park fee.** THB 340 per person on arrival at Khao Sok, plus THB 200 each for the Pakarang cave trail — not included.
- 06 **This is a shape, not a script.** Every night is movable — treat it as a strong default and bend it to your energy.

DOWNLOAD ITINERARY (PDF)

DOWNLOAD CALENDAR (PDF, PRINT LANDSCAPE)

// 14 days · 13 nights · Bangkok — Chiang Mai — Krabi — Khao Sok — Bangkok · Nov 2026